



Some envelopes are lined with bubble wrap to protect objects inside.

Protecting fragile items

- **What?** Bubble wrap
- **Who?** Alfred Fielding and Marc Chavannes
- **Where and when?** US, 1957

In 1957, American engineers Alfred Fielding and Marc Chavannes sealed two shower curtains together, trapping

air bubbles between the layers. They tried to sell it as “3-D wallpaper,” but that venture soon failed. In 1960, they realized this material was perfect for packing fragile items, and bubble wrap was born.

Modern-day highlighter pens



Highlighting text

- **What?** Highlighter pen
- **Who?** Carter's Ink Company
- **Where and when?** US, 1963

Marker pens have been around since the early 20th century, but a felt-tip pen with translucent color that made text stand out without obscuring it was first produced

by Carter's Ink Company in 1963. It was sold under the name Hi-Liter. Although today many colors are available, 85 percent of all purchased highlighters are in fluorescent yellow and pink.

Calculating on the move

- **What?** Electronic calculator
- **Who?** Jack Kilby, Jerry Merryman, James van Tassel, and Clive Sinclair
- **Where and when?** US, 1967

Engineers at the American company Texas Instruments developed the first handheld calculator in 1967. Other companies improved the technology and, by the 1970s, the calculator had become pocket-sized and affordable for everyone.



Canon Pocketronic, 1970

Reusing handwritten notes

- **What?** Post-it notes
- **Who?** Arthur Fry and Spencer Silver
- **Where and when?** US, 1974

After making a unique adhesive by accident, Arthur Fry and Spencer Sullivan came up with sticky, re-usable pieces of paper. It was first marketed as Press 'n Peel in 1977.

